THIS WEEK'S FILE · FOUNDER FILE #010

DANNY POSTMA AND THE AI HEADSHOT BUSINESS BUILT ON SEARCH AND AFFILIATES

A Dutch founder who had already sold one company tried four ideas in about six months, and one of them, AI headshots, took off. He has never been keen to share his revenue, but the company now says it has earned more than $10 million.

THE FILE

FOUNDER	Danny Postma, Founder
COMPANY	HeadshotPro
FOUNDED	2023
HQ	Undisclosed (operator listed as a Singapore company by a third party)
SECTOR	AI headshot generator
STAGE	Bootstrapped, small team
FUNDING	None reported
MODEL	One-time purchases for individuals, credit-based team plans

Hello again, and welcome to File #010. Thank you for reading.

In September 2022, a Dutch founder named Danny Postma watched a new image model called Stable Diffusion appear and did what he had already learned to do: moved fast. By his own account he tried a stock-photo idea, then built a profile-picture app in about 30 hours, then a virtual modelling agency, and then HeadshotPro. Three of those faded. The fourth, he has said, was an instant hit.

This is a file about how a founder with a repeatable method, a distaste for marketing, and a head for search engines built a business that now says it has made more than $10 million. It is also a file about a founder who stopped telling the world how much he earns. (All figures are in US dollars. Most are company-reported or estimates, and we label them.)

THE SHORT VERSION

- **Who:** Danny Postma, a Dutch founder who builds AI products, and who sold his first AI company, Headlime, in 2021.

- **What:** HeadshotPro. You upload a handful of selfies and get professional headshots back. Individuals pay once. Companies buy credits for their teams.
- **Why it matters:** it shows how a one-person business can grow on search traffic and affiliates instead of paid advertising, and what happens to the “solo” label once enterprise customers arrive.
- **The number to remember:** $10 million. That’s the lifetime revenue HeadshotPro now states on its own About page. It’s the company’s claim, not an audited figure, and it’s the first time the business has said anything like it.

THE FOUNDER

Danny started early. By his own account in a 2024 interview, he began a landing-page design gallery called Landingfolio in 2015, at 21, built on WordPress and difficult to monetise. He then built Headlime, a copywriting tool that became an AI product once he got early access to OpenAI’s GPT-3.

He sold Headlime in 2021. Indie Maker List says it went to Conversion.ai, later renamed Jasper, and reports the price as seven figures, which it describes as self-reported. At the time it made about $20,000 a month. On the Bootstrapped Founder podcast he explained why he sold: he had weighed raising investor money, bootstrapping with a team, or selling. Two buyers were interested, and he didn’t want to manage a team. That last reason comes up again.

FOUR IDEAS, ONE HIT

After Stable Diffusion launched, Danny moved quickly. In the 2024 interview he described the sequence:

1. **Stock AI,** an idea for AI stock photos. He worried about image-rights risk and moved on.
2. **ProfilePicture.AI,** built in about 30 hours. It sold well for a week.
3. **Deep Agency,** a virtual modelling service. It got press but few sales.
4. **HeadshotPro,** launched in March 2023. In his words, an instant hit, so he focused on it.

The lesson isn’t that his idea was brilliant. It’s that he had a cheap way to test four ideas in about six months and the discipline to stop working on the three that didn’t take off.

HOW IT WORKS

Most competitors, he says, train a Stable Diffusion model on each customer’s photos using a technique called DreamBooth. He says HeadshotPro runs dozens of additional open-source and custom models and that he spent about a year building its own. He names two open-source tools: LLaVA, which checks uploaded photos and filters inappropriate output, and CodeFormer, which cleans up distortions on faces. Users upload roughly 15 to 17 photos, which he calls the magic number for quality.

Prices today, from the company's site, run from $29 for 30 headshots to $59 for 70 with a higher-resolution upscale. Teams buy one credit per person, with volume discounts of between 20 and 50 percent. There's a money-back guarantee. All of those are company claims. A competitor's review of HeadshotPro found some distortion in the images and rated it 7 out of 10. We note it because the review's author sells a rival product.

THE GROWTH ENGINE: SEARCH FIRST

Danny has been unusually direct about how he chooses what to build. "I only build products where there's SEO," he said on the Bootstrapped Founder. He checks search volume and keyword difficulty in Ahrefs before he starts, and he says he hates marketing, so he relies on search traffic instead.

Two details from that interview stand out.

The domain. He paid $3,000 for headshotpro.com. He argued that a strong domain name matters for search and for stopping competitors from taking your customers. (A cheaper lease-to-own deal on another name, which he abandoned after three months when the product didn't find traction, is part of the same lesson: he tested before buying.)

Older domains as feeders. He bought older domains, such as profilepicturemaker.com, and added banners linking to HeadshotPro, sending existing traffic into the main product.

Secondary analysis, which we can't verify, describes a large programmatic search strategy: pages built for combinations such as job titles and cities. The same source says an attempt at "headshots near me" pages flopped because the content was thin. We'd treat both as plausible and unconfirmed.

THE SECOND ENGINE: AFFILIATES

HeadshotPro runs an affiliate programme through a tool called Rewardful. Rewardful's own case study says the programme generates more than $50,000 a month and contributes over 15 percent of monthly revenue. It gives no date and no number of affiliates, it is written by the vendor, and Danny's quotes in it are testimonials. His argument, which is the useful part, is that affiliates have a reason to write about you, and that without a payment, fewer people would.

Arithmetic worth noting, and clearly ours, not his: if $50,000 is about 15 percent of revenue, the business would be bringing in roughly $330,000 a month. That matches the widely repeated estimate of about $300,000 a month, but each figure rests on a weak source, so the agreement is mildly reassuring, not proof.

WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY

WHAT	CLAIM	HOW RELIABLE
Lifetime revenue	More than $10 million	Company's About page
Customers	250,000 or more (home page), 200,000 or more shoots (About page)	Company
Headshots generated	More than 17 million	Company
Satisfaction and refunds	96.7% satisfied, 3.3% requested a refund, across about 217,879 purchases from 2023 to 2026	Company
Monthly revenue	About $300,000, or $3.6 million a year	Third-party estimates, widely repeated
Affiliate programme	More than $50,000 a month	Vendor case study
Early revenue	About $100,000 in two weeks after launch	Secondary sites

A rough check, again our arithmetic: 217,879 purchases at $29 to $59 each comes to somewhere between $6 million and $13 million over three and a half years. That brackets the $10 million claim. It doesn't verify it, because team discounts, promotions and refunds all push it around.

WHY HE STOPPED SHARING

In August 2023, on the podcast, he said: "I don't share revenue anymore. Sorry." He gave no reason, and he hasn't published a number since. It's a perfectly legitimate choice, and it means every figure about HeadshotPro is something someone else has estimated, or something the company says about itself. Treat all of it that way.

SOLO, AND THEN NOT

Danny called himself a solopreneur in 2023, with a caveat. On the podcast he said that servers went down overnight in the early days, that the product had become robust enough for support to wait, that refunds and support were automated, and that his wife helped for two or three hours a day. He had also posted his first job listing, for a machine learning engineer, and wanted a small remote team in one time zone. He also said he was "really nervous" about launching a team plan for companies.

By 2024 he said he had started with contractors and part-timers and that he should have begun building a team sooner. A third-party directory now lists the company as 1 to 10 people, and an industry dataset from mid-2025 lists the operator as a Singapore-based company. Those are estimates. The company's site also claims SOC 2 Type II compliance, a data-processing agreement and single sign-on for teams of 1,000 or more. You don't normally get those from a solo operation. We couldn't confirm the current headcount.

Try this

Build only where there's search. Before you start, check the monthly searches and how hard it is to rank for the thing you'd sell. If nobody is searching for it, you'll need another way in.

Test several ideas cheaply, and stop most of them. Set a time and a sales target for each one before you start.

Add an affiliate programme early. Pay people who write about you, track it properly, and treat it as a second engine alongside search.

Automate refunds and first-line support so you can take a holiday. Decide in advance what gets refunded automatically.

Write down what you'll do when you stop being solo. The question he ended up on was who to hire first.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Opacity. The company's numbers are its own, and the founder has chosen not to publish his. That makes it hard to judge what the business is really doing.

Competition. It's a crowded category. Competitors claim higher resolution, faster delivery and stronger security certifications. Search and affiliate advantages can erode as others copy them.

Search itself. A business built on ranking depends on how search engines treat AI-generated and thin content, and on how they change what they show.

Photos of faces. The product handles customers' photos. The company says it doesn't use them to train its models and deletes them after 30 days, and it claims strong security. Those are claims. Face images are sensitive, and the regulatory rules for them vary by place.

Quality. Customers judge headshots on how they look. Distortions in a small share of results can turn into complaints and refunds.

WHAT TO WATCH

1. **Whether the company publishes more numbers,** and whether anyone outside it confirms the $10 million.
2. **The team.** Who works there, and how a company with enterprise customers is run.
3. **The affiliate programme.** Whether it keeps growing and how much of the revenue it carries.
4. **Competition on quality.** Whether HeadshotPro's models keep up as others improve theirs.

A founder who sells something once, to millions of people, and who is open about nothing except his method. In this series, the method is the useful part.

That's File #010. Thank you for reading it. If it made you think of someone, forward it along, and if there's a founder you'd like to see opened next, tell us at info@aifounderfiles.com. File #011 lands next Sunday.

Where this came from: Danny Postma's podcast and press interviews, the company's own site, a vendor case study, and third-party estimates we label as such. We have not spoken to him or verified any revenue figure. Claude, made by Anthropic, helped research and draft this file. Spotted a mistake? Email info@aifounderfiles.com and we'll correct it.

SOURCES

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